On June 6, 1982, Israel's Defense Force entered Lebanon not to conquer territory but to fight and smash the armed bands operating from that country against our land and its citizens.

This, the IDF did. You will remember we could not accept your suggestion that we proclaim a cease fire on Thursday, June 10, because at that time the enemy was still 18 kilometers from Metulla on our northern border. However, 24 hours later, we pushed the enemy northward and on Friday, June 11, we proclaimed a unilateral cease fire rejected by the terrorists so the fighting continued. And on June 27, we suggested all the terrorists leave Beirut, Lebanon, which they eventually did with the important good offices of Ambassador Habib many weeks later.

. . . [in the intervening battles] Israel lost 340 men killed and 2,200 wounded, 100 of them severely. Also in the battles following the rejection of our appeals by the Syrian army not to interfere, the IDF destroyed 405 Soviet Syrian tanks, among them 9 T72's, considered in NATO circles to be invulnerable; we downed 102 Soviet-Syrian MIGs, including one MIG-25, and smashed 21 batteries of SAM6 and SAM8 and SAM9, a deadly weapon. . . .

Yet in your letter to me and in your speech to the American people you did not, Mr. President, even mention the bravery of the Israeli fighters nor the great sacrifices of the Israeli army and people. One could have gotten the impression that Mr. Philip Habib with the help of expeditionary units achieved the results. Mr. President, I was struck by this omission, but to state a fact, I do not complain.

I do protest your omission to consult Israel before your decision to forward your proposals to Jordan and Saudi Arabia, the former an outspoken opponent of the